



Commission on Dental Accreditation

Via Email Transmission: wendi.tostenson@volstate.edu

March 4, 2026

Dr. Wendi Tostenson
President
Volunteer State Community College
1480 Nashville Pike
Gallatin, TN 37066

RE: Volunteer State Community College, Gallatin, Tennessee
Dental Assisting Program
Status: Approval without Reporting Requirements

Dear Dr. Tostenson,

At its February 5, 2026 meeting, the Commission on Dental Accreditation (CODA) granted the dental assisting program the accreditation status of “**approval without reporting requirements.**” The definitions of accreditation classifications are linked below. Below is a summary of actions and additional information.

Dental Assisting (Site Visit)

The Commission considered the site visit report on the dental assisting program. The Commission also considered the institution’s response to the site visit report.

On the basis of this review, the Commission determined that the recommendations cited in the report have been met and adopted a resolution to grant the program the accreditation status of “approval without reporting requirements.”

No additional information is requested from the program at this time. The next site visit for the program is scheduled for **2032**.

General Information

The findings of the Commission on Dental Accreditation are noted in the attached Commission approved site visit report. Oral comments made by site visit team members during the course of the site visit are not to be construed as official site visit findings unless documented within the site visit report and may not be publicized. Further, publication of site visit team members’ names and/or contact information is prohibited.

One copy of this report has also been sent to the chief administrative officer and program director copied on this letter. The Commission requests that a copy of this report be forwarded to the chairpersons and appropriate faculty.

The Commission expects institutions to keep the Commission informed as soon as possible of anticipated changes in any approved educational program offered, particularly in the areas of administration, enrollment, faculty, facilities and curriculum. The Commission’s policy and

guidelines for reporting program changes are linked below. Guidelines for specific program changes, including reporting enrollment changes, adding sites where educational activity occurs, and developing a teach-out report are found on the Commission's website.

Institutions/Programs are expected to follow Commission policy and procedure on privacy and data security related to compliance with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA). The Commission's statement on HIPAA, as well as the Privacy and Data Security Summary for Institutions/Programs (PDF), are found in the Policies/Guidelines section of the Commission's website at <https://coda.ada.org/policies-and-guidelines/hipaa-compliance>. Programs that fail to comply with CODA's policy will be assessed an administrative fee of \$4000.

The Commission has authorized use of the following statement by institutions or programs that wish to announce their programmatic accreditation by the Commission. Programs that wish to advertise the specific programmatic accreditation status granted by the Commission may include that information as indicated in italics below (see text inside square brackets); that portion of the statement is optional but, if used, must be complete and current.

The program in dental assisting is accredited by the Commission on Dental Accreditation *[and has been granted the accreditation status of "approval without reporting requirements"]*. The Commission is a specialized accrediting body recognized by the United States Department of Education. The Commission on Dental Accreditation can be contacted at (800) 232-6108 or at 401 North Michigan Avenue, Suite 3300, Chicago, IL 60611-4250. The Commission's web address is: <https://coda.ada.org/>.

The Commission wishes to thank you and the faculty and staff for their cooperation during the site visit. If this office can be of any assistance to you, please contact me by telephone, at 312-440-4660 or by e-mail asherhernandezj@ada.org.

Sincerely,



Jamie Asher Hernandez, MS
Manager, Allied Dental Accreditation
Commission on Dental Accreditation

JAH/ds

Web Links: [CODA Accreditation Status Definitions](#)
[Guidelines for Reporting Program Changes in Accredited Programs](#)
[Electronic Submission Guidelines for General Correspondence](#)

Attachment: Formal Report of the Site Visit

cc: Ms. Kimberly Christmon, dean, Health Sciences, Volunteer State Community College, kim.christmon@volstate.edu
Ms. Desiree Sutphen, program director, Dental Assisting Program, Volunteer State Community College, desiree.sutphen@volstate.edu
Ms. Elizabeth Daggett, director, Accreditation Division, U.S. Department of Education (via

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CODA website)

State Boards of Dentistry (via CODA website)

Institutional Accreditors (via CODA website)

Dr. Cataldo W. Leone, chair, Commission on Dental Accreditation (CODA)

Dr. Kathleen J. Hinshaw, senior director, Commission on Dental Accreditation